

Apple Passwords App

Duke OLLI Digital Explorers SIG

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Using a password manager	This section gives you a brief overview of password managers in general and a more detailed overview of Apple's password manager: the Passwords app. This app has all the core features of a quality password manager. While you may want to use another password manager at some point in the future, the Passwords app is a great place to start!	16 - 28
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Key Terms

account	In a conceptual (or abstract) sense: An agreement you have with a company or organization to use their online business or service(s). If you have an account with an online business or service, you have an agreement with them to use their business or service. In a practical (or applicable) sense: A digital identity, such as a user name, password and associated data (e.g., email address, cell phone number, age, etc), that you use to access—in a secure, private, and/or personalized way—a site and/or service(s) that exists on the Internet.
identity	A collection of information (i.e., data) tied to a specific user, device, or other “entity” (e.g., an app or file) in a digital environment (e.g., your devices collectively or a digital network). This collection of information for a user/device/entity is unique relative to the collection of information for all other users/devices/entities in the same digital environment.
token	A piece of data used to represent an identity. The use of tokens is ubiquitous with internet sites and the apps we use to access internet sites (e.g., browsers). Tokens are typically created/generated by a site and sent to the device/app you are using to access the site. E.g., when you successfully sign in to a site using your browser, the site creates a token that represents your identify on that site as well as the “fact” that you are signed in; the site sends this token back to your browsers once you have successfully signed in; your browser will then send this token <i>back</i> to the site in the next request your browser sends to the site and that is how the site “knows” the request is coming from a signed in user and who that use is. We don’t interact with tokens directly when using our devices and apps; the software on our device and on the site(s) we’re accessing manages any tokens being used for us. So why am I bothering to define the term here? Given that an identity is an collection of information that uniquely describes you, to maintain your privacy a site should not share collection of information about my identity with others. I.e. a site would be undermining my online privacy if it sent the collection of information it uses to define my identity. Instead, a site sense the token it creates/generates that <i>represents</i> my identity.

Key terms: Authentication, Credentials & Factors

- The term “**sign in**” refers to the action(s) you take to access an account you have with a site on the Internet.
- “**Sign on**”, “**log on**”, and “**log in**” are synonymous terms; note that sometimes each of these terms are written as hyphenated words (e.g., “log-in”) and sometimes they are written as compound words (e.g., “login”).
- The “formal” computer science term is **authentication**.
- When you sign in to a site—i.e., authenticate with a site—you are proving your identity. The word “identity” in this context means “the owner of the account.”
- When signing in to a site, you provide the site some information it needs to verify that you are in fact the owner of the account you are signing in to. E.g., when signing into a Google account, you can enter either your Gmail address or your cell phone number along with a password. In this scenario, the email address or phone number you provide is representing your identity (i.e., it is the piece of information that tells Google *who* is signing in.) In the context of signing in—or authenticating—this piece of information is often referred to as your **user id** (sometimes written as “userid” or simply “id”; aka “**user name**”).
- Sometimes when signing in you may also have to provide a code sent to you by the site (i.e., when the account is configured to use two-factor authentication.)
- Each piece of information you have to provide in addition to your user id is called a authentication **factor**. E.g., your user id and password are factors; the six digit code a site sends you in an email or text that you then enter is a factor.
- Regardless of how many “pieces” of information you have to provide a site when signing in/authenticating, they are collectively referred to as **credentials**.

More on Authentication Factors

- An authentication factor represents a piece of information or an attribute that is used to verify/validate that you —the person requesting access to the site— are indeed the same person that created (and therefore is said to “own”) the account you are logging into on the site.

- Factors fall into three categories:

- Something you *know* (aka, a knowledge factor)

User ids and passwords fall into this category. PINs are also an example of this type of factor.

- Something you *have* (aka, a possession factor)

The 6-digit code you receive via text/email when you have 2FA enabled for an account is an example of this type of factor. When a 6-digit code is sent to you via text, you have to have the phone the code was sent to in your possession in order to use it; when a code is sent to you via email, you have to be in possession of the inbox associated that email address.

- Something you *are* (aka, an inherence factor)

This factor depends on biometric identification. I.e., fingerprint and/or facial recognition.

Term: One Time Passwords (OTP)

More on 6-digit codes used with 2FA

- The codes a site sends you when you have 2FA enabled on your account for that site are also called **one time passwords (OTP)**. One time passwords have a couple of key attributes:
 - *An OTP can only be used once.*
 - *An OTP has an expiration period.*

An OTP must be used within a specific period of time; after that period of time has past, an OTP will no longer work. I.e., OTPs expire. How long before an OTP expires is determined by the site you are signing into using 2FA. Some sites tell you how long an OTP is valid while others do not. OTPs sent to you via text or email, the expiration period is typically 10-15 minutes from the moment the site sends the OTP. Note this moment is not the same as the moment you receive the OTP.

- Note that while OTPs used with 2FA are typically made up of six digits, they can be comprised of fewer than or more than six digits; they can also contain letters of the alphabet in addition to digits (although both of these kinds of cases are very rare among Internet sites that support 2FA).

Key term: Authorization

Note: I am introducing you to the concept of authorization because of its close relationship to authentication with regards to cybersecurity. This document does not go into further details of authorization processes or when/how you interact with (i.e., use) them.

- **Authorization** is a fundamental cybersecurity concept that is closely related to **authentication**. These two concepts are so closely related that they are sometimes used interchangeably. I.e., “computer geeks” sometimes use the words “authorize” and “authorization” when they are actually referring to the process of authenticating.
- **Authentication** is the process of verifying who a person is, while **authorization** is the process of verifying what they have access to.
- Definition of **authorization**: the act of granting or denying permission to a person (i.e., “user”), app, or device to access some other digital resource (e.g., data, file(s), features).
- An analogy: When you go through security at an airport, you show your ID to authenticate your identity. Then, when you arrive at the gate, you present your boarding pass to the flight attendant, so they can authorize you to board your flight and allow access to the plane.
- **Authorization** always occurs after **authentication**. I.e., a person, app, or device’s identity has to be established before the system can determine what that person, app, or device is allowed to do.
- Examples of authorization
 - Social media sites often have settings that allow you to decide who can see post you make on the site. At one point in time (I don’t know if this is still the case today), Facebook included some settings that allowed you to limit who could see your posts to (1) only Facebook users you “friended”, (2) users you “friended” and users your “friends” also directly “friended”, or (3) any/all Facebook users.
 - Some apps need to use your device’s camera, mic, or location service for some of their features. Apple realizes an app’s ability to use these components/features could compromise your privacy, so Apple products ask you if you want to allow such apps to use those services. If/when you say “yes”, you are granting permission (i.e., authorizing) to the app to use that component or feature.

Types of Authentication Methods

Single-factor (SFA)	Authentication using only a user id and password.
Two-factor (2FA)	Authentication using one factor in addition to a user id and password. This additional factor is typically (always?) a 6-digit code—called a “one-time password” (or OTP) that is either (1) sent to you by the site you are signing into in a text or email or (2) generated by an authenticator app.
Multi-factor (MFA)	Authentication using two or more factors in addition to a user id and password. An example of MFA that you encounter with some sites involve the use of “security questions” (e.g., “what was your childhood pet’s name?” and “what is your mother’s maiden name?”). Sites that collect your answers to these kinds of questions sometimes make you answer one or more of these questions in addition to providing a 6-digit code are employing MFA. Note: consider 2FA and MFA are synonymous in the remainder of this document.
Passwordless	This method does not use passwords or other factors; instead a specific type of cryptography—called <i>public-key cryptography</i> or <i>asymmetric cryptography</i> —is used. Passkeys use this method. Passkeys are strings of alphanumeric characters (i.e., letters and digits); they can be up to 300 alphanumeric characters in length. Given the maximum possible length of passkeys, typing a passkey is awkward and error prone (not to mention impossible to remember!) Therefore, you must use a password manager to use passkeys.
Social Sign-On (SSO)	Authentication using your existing credentials for a site “p” (like, Facebook, Google, Twitter or Apple) to sign in to another site “q”. This primary benefit of this method is that you don’t have to create an account on the other site “q” (i.e., one less set of credentials to remember/manage); the primary downside of this method is that if you loose access to site “p”, you also loose access to site “q”; a secondary downside is that site “p” has the ability to track your activity on site “q”. This method is also called social login and single-sign on.

Note: the remainder of this document focuses on 2FA. The terms 2FA and MFA are sometimes used interchangeably although they are technically different.

Relatively few internet sites use MFA in any meaningful way. “True” MFA is most typically used businesses/organizations that give their employees/members “internal accounts” (i.e., accounts to access computer systems in the company/organization’s data center(s).)

Relative Strengths of Authentication Methods

Internet sites that require an account to use its services may support some but not all the authentication methods previously outlined in this document. Not all sites that support 2FA will support each of the three different ways 2FA can be configured; e.g., some may allow you to use 2FA with email/text but not authenticator apps. Passkeys are a relatively new technology; many internet sites have yet to support passkeys.

When a site supports more than one of these methods, you can choose which you want to use with your account. Some of the available authentication methods provide a greater degree of security than others. We want our Internet accounts to be as secure as possible, so when a site gives you choices among authentication methods you generally want to choose the method that is the most secure. The table on the right shows the relative strengths between authentication methods; the higher the number, the more secure the method is.

Regarding the relative strengths of 2FA methods: there is some debate among cybersecurity experts regarding the relative strengths of receiving 2FA OTPs via email versus via text. Most experts consider receiving OTPs via text as more secure than via email. Cybersecurity experts agree that using an authenticator app with 2FA is more secure than either of the 2FA methods.

Note that if you share your credentials for some account(s) with other people (i.e., family or friends), using passkeys or one of the 2FA methods with an account you share may complicate sharing that account with others. For example, imagine I want to share my Netflix account with another person who does live under the same roof as I do and I have 2FA with text enabled on that account. While I can tell the other person my Netflix account user ID and password, when the other person attempts to sign in to my Netflix account, the OTP is going to be sent to my phone! If I'm not around/available when the other person is signing in to my Netflix account, they will not be able to get the OTP sent to my phone from me and therefore not be able to complete the sign-in process.

Method	Relative Strength
SFA	1
2FA with email	2
2FA with text (aka, SMS)	3
2FA with authenticator app	4
Passkeys	5

Regarding Social Sign-On (SSO)

The strength of authenticating using SSO is the same as the strength of the authentication method used by the account you are signing *in with*. E.g., If I use my Apple account to login to YouTube via SSO, the strength of my YouTube authentication method is the same as my Apple authentication method.

What are passkeys?

And why are they the strongest authentication method?

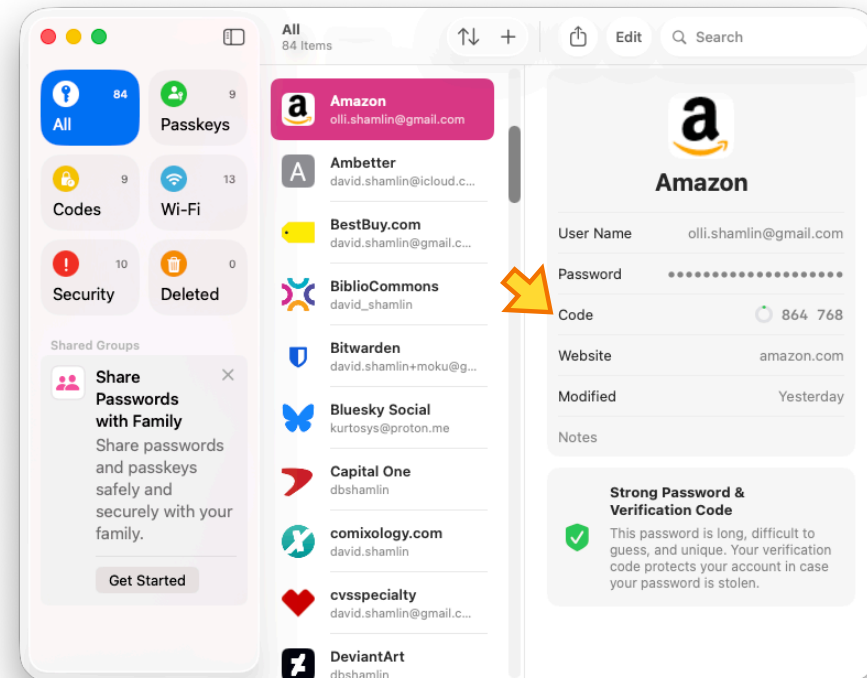
- **Definition:** A passkey is a form of multifactor authentication that uses public key cryptography in combination with biometrics like fingerprint and facial recognition or a device PIN to verify an account owner's identity. Passkeys act as a replacement for traditional passwords. (microsoft.com)
- Passkeys [are] *safer and more convenient than passwords* because they work in a fundamentally different way. Passwords are what you'd call a "shared secret" in the world of cybersecurity. You know the secret, and so does the [site] you're signing in to. The problem is that you have to remember that secret, and you aren't fully in control of it, as you have to share that secret with whatever [site] you're using. A data breach and a little decryption time are all that's needed to end up with a compromised account, and you didn't even do anything wrong. (wired.com)
- Passkeys *use public-key cryptography*. Instead of matching a shared secret, public-key cryptography works by matching a pair of keys—a public key that anyone can see, and a private key that only you have access to. It's safer because only you have access to your private key, and it's easier because that key is bound to some device you own and usually secured with biometrics. (wired.com)
- Passkeys are tricky because they fly in the face of security conventions that have been around for years—namely, two-factor (2FA) or multifactor authentication (MFA). Although you don't need to plug in a code from a text or copy something over from an authenticator app, passkeys *inherently use multifactor authentication*. It just happens so fast that it's easy to miss. (wired.com)
- See Session 8 hand outs from Tech Skills 101 course for more.

What is an Authenticator App?

- An authenticator app generates time-sensitive, one-time passwords (**OTPs**) used for two-factor authentication (**2FA**) or multi-factor authentication (**MFA**).
- Authenticator apps generate OTPs directly on your device. This is the primary reason using 2FA with an authenticator app is more secure than using 2FA with text or email. When you use 2FA with text/email the OTP is generated on the site you are signing in to and then sent to you by the site via a text message or an email; a bad actor (i.e., hacker) can theoretically intercept/steal the text message or email containing the OTP and use it to hack your account. Authenticator apps remove this security risk by eliminating the 2FA authorization step of transmitting the OTP from the site to your device.
- Popular authenticator apps are Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, 2FAS, and Authy.
- It is common for authenticator apps to only be supported on smart phones but not on tablets or laptops.
- The Passwords app has authenticator app includes an authenticator app feature! I.e., you can take advantage of the most secure variety of 2FA without having to install/configure/use yet another app.

Using an Authenticator App

- To use 2FA with an authenticator app, you must perform a step that you do not perform when using 2FA with text or email. The purpose of this step is to “introduce” the authenticator app you are using to the site you want to enable 2FA with the authenticator app on.
- When you select/enable a site’s settings for 2FA with an authenticator app, the site will present you with a QR code and/or an OTP-type code (i.e., a string of digits and/or characters). You then either scan the QR code with your iPhone’s camera or you type the OTP-type code into your authenticator app.
- When you then later sign-in to the account and the site prompts you to enter a 2FA OTP, you enter the 6-digit code you see in the authenticator app for that account.
- The image on the right shows a Passwords app record for an Amazon account that is configured to use 2FA with an authenticator app. (Highlighted by the yellow arrow.) Note the “Code” field in this record. That field contains the OTP value you are two used when prompted by the site to enter a 2FA OTP.
 - **Note:** The value you see in this field will change every 30 seconds.
 - **Note:** When viewing (not editing) a record in the Passwords app, you will only see the “Code” field when you have complete the step described above to “introduce” the Passwords app’s authenticator app feature to the site associated with the Passwords app’s record.



Creating an Account: How the information you provide is used

- When you create an account on a site, the site prompts you for several pieces of information. Exactly what information a site prompts you for depends on the site as well as the information/choices you make as you go through the account creation process. The pieces of information you provide fall into one or more of the following categories:
 - **Personally Identifying Information (PII)**
Information that specifically identifies you in the “physical world”. E.g., name, email address, phone number, birthdate.
 - **Digital Identify**
Information that is (in essence) collectively your account credentials. Minimally, this includes a piece of information that acts as the user id and a password value. Some sites use the (existing) email address or phone number to act as your user id that you provide. Note that some sites (Google is an example) allow you to use both your gmail address and your phone number as your user id.
 - **Authorization Method**
Sites that support 2FA and passkeys will typically give you the option of enabling them during the course of creating an account. If you decline the options of using 2FA and/or passkeys, you can return to your account at a later time to enable them; this is typically done using the account settings pages when sign-ed in to the site in your browser.

Password Reset vs Account Recovery

- It happens to everyone at some point: you lose or forget the password for one of your accounts. If/when this happens, most sites provide one or more ways to get back into your account.
- If you lose the password for an account that is using SFA (i.e., user id and password only), you can **reset** the account's password. Look for a link that says something like "Forgot your password?" or "Reset your password" on the site's sign-in page. Click that link and the site will send you an email or text that contains a link that you can click on to reset your password.
- If you lose the password for an account that is using MFA or an account that is using passkeys, you can't use the site's "reset password" feature; instead you need to use a **recovery code** generated by the site. When you enabled MFA or passkey sign-on for an account, the site should give you one or more recovery codes. You need to save a copy of those codes somewhere so that you can use them if/when you lose your password or passkey for that site.
 - **Tip:** You can save recovery codes for an account in the "Notes" field of that account's entry in your Passwords app!

Remember me; Leave me signed in; Trust this browser

- Some site's sign-in pages include checkboxes with labels that say things like "remember me", "leave me signed in", and "trust this browser"
- Enabling these checkboxes when you see them is a safe thing to do as long as you only do it when using your devices. Never enable these checkboxes if/when you are signing in to a site using a device you don't own.
- "Remember me" causes your browser to remember the user id you enter (so you don't have to enter it yourself the next time you sign in)
- "Leave me signed in" causes your browser to save the authorization token the site creates after you successfully sign in. The next time you "return" to the site using the same browser on the same device (even if you have closed/quite your browser and/or turned off your device in the interim), you will still be signed in to your account.
- "Trust this browser" will only appear if you have 2FA enabled with the account. If you enable this checkbox, you will not have enter a OTP the next time you sign in to the site using the same browser on the same device you used when enabling this checkbox.
- **Note:** If/when you enable any of these checkboxes, a cookie is created and saved by your browser; the cookie "represents" the fact that you enabled the associated checkbox. This means that if you clear your browser's cache, the fact that you enabled these checkboxes will be "forgotten." Also, these cookies have "expiration dates," and after some period of time, you will have to repeat the authentication steps associated with the checkbox(es) you enabled.

What is a Password Manager

- Software that stores the credentials of your accounts. Most modern password managers make it easy to enter an account's credentials when sign in to websites and apps. A password manager “remembers” your accounts’ credentials so you don’t have to. However, because the password manager holds the keys to your entire digital life, it’s crucial that your password manager itself is secure.
- There are some key categories/types of password managers:
 - Stand-alone: Password managers of this type are apps of this type. Apple’s Passwords app is an example of this type of password manager. Digital tech and security experts recommend using this type of password manager; they tend to be more trustworthy (i.e., more secure) than other types of password managers. Password managers of this type provide a broader/richer set of features and a greater degree of flexibility than password managers in the other categories..
 - Integrated: Password managers of this type are specific to a browser and come in two varieties: built-in and third-party. Built-in password managers are included with the browsers; Chrome browser include a built in password manager. Third-party password managers are packaged as browser extensions that you download and install into your browser.

Integrated password managers are only usable inside the associate browser; have a small/minimum set of features; and have a history of being less secure than high quality stand-alone password managers. (I.e., there are certainly stand-alone password managers that are not sufficiently secure and therefore not trustworthy; it is important to carefully investigate/research any password managers security features and history before you start using it.)
- Stand-alone password managers themselves use a **master password** to prevent unauthorized access. This means that if you use a password manager, you only need to remember its master password instead of remembering the passwords for all your accounts. But you should make sure that your master password is hard to guess.
- Stand-alone password managers store your credentials in a file often often referred to as a **vault**. These digital **vaults** are encrypted using a password of your choosing; a **vault** password is often referred to as **master password**. A vault’s password is not remembered (i.e., stored) by the password manager itself; if you loose/forget the vault’s password, you will no longer be able to access the credentials of accounts you have added to your password manager.
 - Note: Apple introduced a password manager app—names “Passwords” with macOS Sequoia and iOS 18. While Apple’s Passwords app has a smaller set of features than most other trustworthy stand-alone password managers, it supports enough “typical” password manager features for it to be useable, and it is sufficiently secure to make it trustworthy. Also, you do not need to choose a **master password** yourself to encrypt its **vault**; instead the Passwords app uses your Apple device’s authentication methods like facial recognition, fingerprint recognition, and device password/passcode. This ensures only you can access the information you store in the Passwords app; it also eliminates the need to remember a master password to access the Passwords app’s **vault**.

Apple's Password Management



Passwords
app icon



Keychain Access
app icon

- Passwords app
 - This app is a bona fide password manager. Similar to how you use the Contacts app to have convenient access to key pieces of information (e.g., phone number, email address, home address, birthday, etc) for members of your family and your friends/acquaintances, the Passwords app gives you convenient access to the credentials for accounts you create. You can also access the passwords for any secure Wi-Fi networks you use (and tell your device to remember).
 - Apple first released with macOS Sequoia and iOS 18.
 - Prior to those OS releases, you used the **Keychain Access app** to see any account passwords you saved on your device. However, the Keychain Access app is not a true password manager; it lacks many of the key features expected of password managers. Apple is in the process of deprecating (i.e., ending) it's support of the Keychain Access app; it is not included with iOS 26 (although for complete transparency I have not been able to determine in which iOS release Apple removed the Keychain Access app from iOS.) The Keychain Access app is still included with macOS (as of macOS Tahoe Version 26), but tech industry analysts expect Apple to remove the Keychain Access app from macOS at some point in the future too.)
- Keychain service
 - The Keychain service is a key part of Apple's password management system. The Keychain service has two primary features:
 1. It manages the storage of account credentials
For awareness, the Keychain service also stores some other kinds of information as well. E.g., any Wi-Fi networks that require a password to use (and tell your device to remember) and any credit card information you add to the Wallet app are store in/by the Keychain service.
 2. Syncs your account credentials across your devices (via your iCloud Drive)
 - The Keychain service is different than the Keychain Access app mentioned above. The Keychain Access app provides a user interface (UI) to access the information managed/stored by the Keychain service.
 - Note: The word **service** in this context refers to a piece of software that is managed by the operating system. Services are often launched/started by the OS when you turn on your devices; some services are launched/started when an app that uses the service is launched/started. You do not directly interact with services.
 - The Passwords app depends on the Keychain service for the storage of account credentials you see/add to the Passwords app. I.e., the Passwords app and Keychain service work together; the Passwords app provide you with a user interface to see, add, and edit the credentials of accounts you save on your devices while the Keychain service takes care of where and how those credentials are stored and synced between your devices.
 - Apple currently refer to this service as the **iCloud Keychain** in their user/help documentation.

Passwords App: account fields

Each entry (aka, **record**) in your Passwords app contains the following pieces of information (i.e., **fields**):

- Account name
- Site icon (i.e., brand logo)
- User name
- Password
- Code
- Website
- Modified
- Notes

Passwords App: account fields

Each entry (aka, **record**) in your Passwords app contains the following pieces of information (i.e., **fields**):

Account name	The Passwords app will set this field to either the host name of the associated site or the name of the company/organization that owns the site. E.g., if I let my device save the credentials for my Amazon account, this field will either get set to "amazon.com" or "Amazon". Which value the Passwords app uses depends on an app settings. If you don't like the value the app chooses, you can change it.
Site icon	Some sites have an icon; for sites that do, they are usually the brand logo of the company/organization that owns the site. If "Allow Contacting Websites" app setting is turned on, the Passwords app will attempt to determine if the site does have an icon and show the icon along with the account name. If the related app setting is turned off or the site does not have an icon, then the Passwords app will show the first letter of the account name instead of the site icon.
User name	The value that you enter into the user id textbox on a sign in web page or app sign-in dialog. Note that some sites allow you to use more than one value as a user id. E.g., both Google and Facebook sign-pages allow you to enter either an email address or cell phone number in their user name textboxes. For such sites, this Passwords app fields can be either of the supported types of values.
Password	As this field's name implies, the password you use to sign-in to the associated account goes in this field. Note that the value you see in this field in the Password apps UI will normally be a series of "dots" (i.e., "●●●●●●●●●●●●●●●●"). The Passwords app does this for security reasons (i.e., to prevent anyone looking over your shoulder from being able to read your password.) You can reveal the actual password value by hovering your cursor over the series of dots on a Macbook and tapping on the series of dots on your iPhone/iPad.
Website	The Passwords app <u>appears</u> to store the hostname(s) of the associated site's sign-in page(s) (i.e., URL(s)) in this field. A site may have more than one page to sign-in; when this is the case, you may see more than one hostname in this field. Note and also for full transparency, other password managers I have used store the site's sign-in page(s) full URL in this field; I so far haven't found in any Apple documentation any statement that the Passwords app only stores hostnames in this field or if it store full URLs but only shows you hostnames in its UI.
Code	This field is only used with accounts that you enable 2FA for use with an authenticator app. When you add your credentials for such accounts into the Passwords app, you will see in this field the 6-digit OTP code you enter when you are prompted to enter a 2FA code.
Modified	The value in this field is populated by the Passwords app. It contains the date any of the other field of the associate Passwords app entry were last modified.
Notes	This is a free form text field that you can use to securely save any additional information with your accounts credentials.

Passwords App Features

- Manually
 - Add a new account
 - Edit an existing account
 - Delete an exiting account
 - Share an account record with a person or group of people
- “Save this password” dialogs
 - Does this feature work with third-party browsers?*
- Strong password generator
- Built-in authenticator app
- Autofill
 - With sign-in pages in your browser
 - With apps that require you to sign in to an account
 - Note: getting auto-fill to work with browsers other than Safari (i.e., a “third-party browser”) may require you to install an extension for the third-party browser(s)
- Identify for security concerns: checks for weak, commonly used, reused passwords, and passwords that have been leaked

Passwords App UI Overview

The Passwords app's UI is fairly simple to understand and use. There are many similarities between the Passwords app UI and the Contacts app UI; if you're already comfortable using the Contacts app, you should be able to "wrap your head around" the Passwords app UI without too much effort.

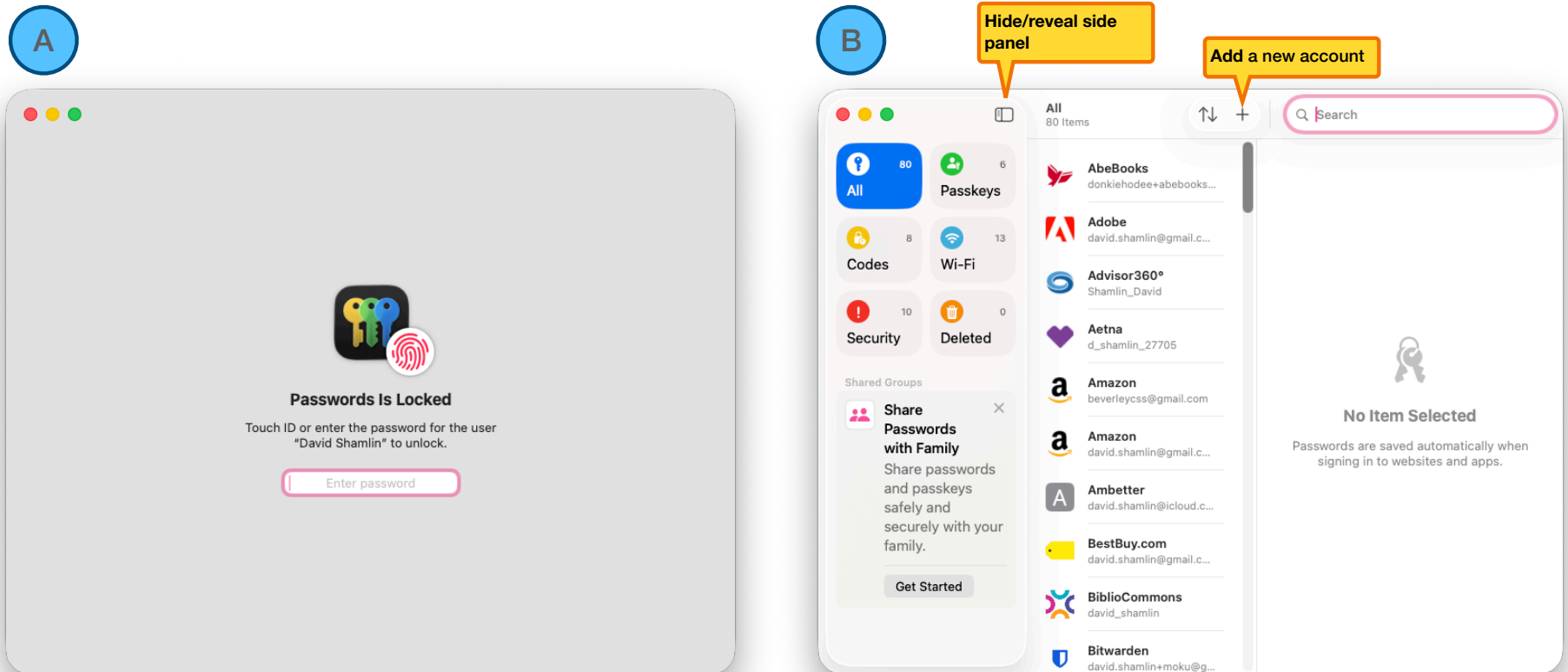
Assuming you sign in to at least some of your internet accounts on more than one of your devices, you are going to use the Passwords app on each of your devices. Given that, it's worth familiarizing yourself with the Passwords app's UI on all of your devices. In particular, noticing the similarities/differences between your devices of the app's views and controls should increase your effectiveness and reduce your effort doing things with the app as you "bounce between" using the app on each of your devices.

The Passwords app has five primary views that are listed in the table to the right. The remaining pages in this section show you examples of these views on the Mac, iPhone, and iPad. The circled letters in the table to the left appear beside the screenshots on the following pages to help you familiarize yourself with what each of the five primary views look like on each type of device.

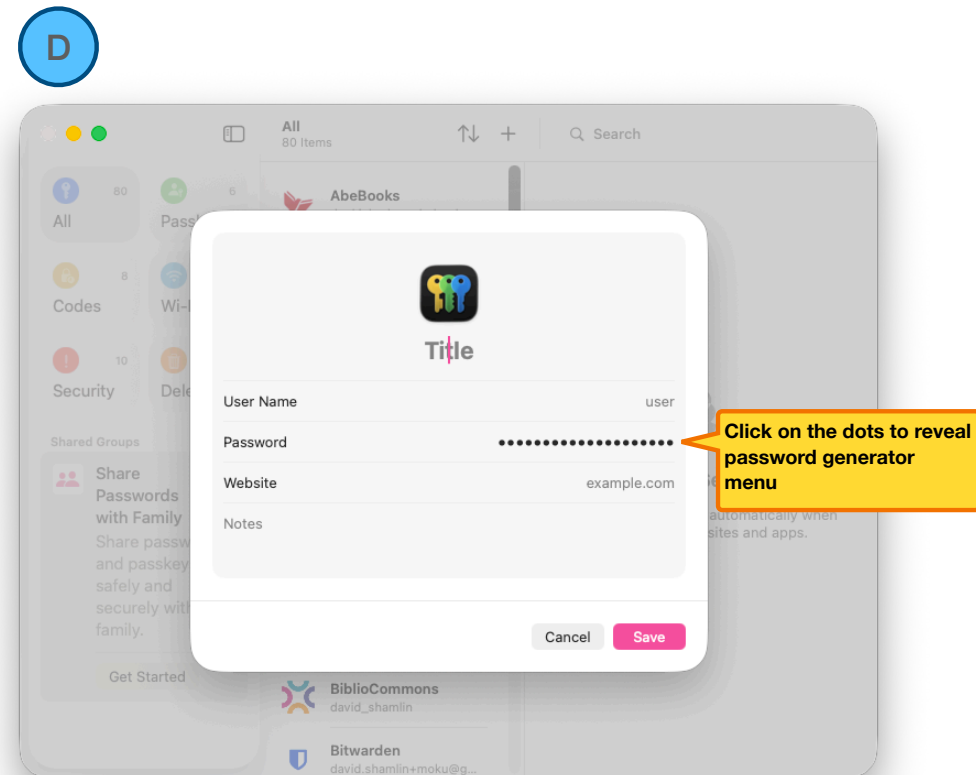
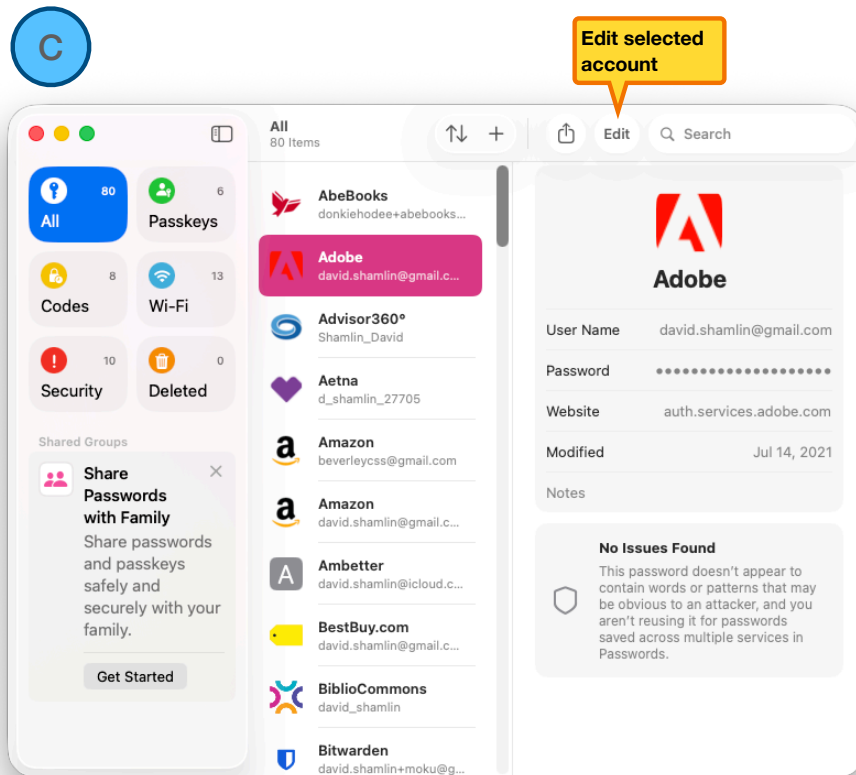
Key controls that appear on various screens are also highlighted on the following pages.

	Lock screen view: You encounter this view when opening the Passwords app. If you leave the Passwords app running in the background, the app will return to this view after a period of time. You unlock the app from this screen using your device's biometric key, main password on Macs, or main passcode on iPhones/iPads.
	Main view: You enter this view after unlocking the Passwords app. This view allows you to browse/find entries in your vault.
	Read view: This view allows you to access the credentials of an account you have stored in your vault. You enter this view by selecting an item from the pane/view that lists all the accounts you have in your vault. On Macs, you can reveal the account's password by hovering over the password field (i.e., the series of dots); clicking/tapping on the user name and password fields will cause those values to be copied to the clipboard.
	Add view: This view allows you to enter an account's credentials when you create a new account on a site. You enter this view by clicking on the add button that is visible on the main view. Note your device can often create new entries in your vault for you. When creating a new account on a website or signing in to an existing account whose credentials are not stored in your vault, your device will show a dialog asking if you want to save your credentials. If you say "yesterday" to this prompt, the account's credentials will be added to your vault.
	Edit view: This view allows you to edit the credentials of an account you previously added to your vault.

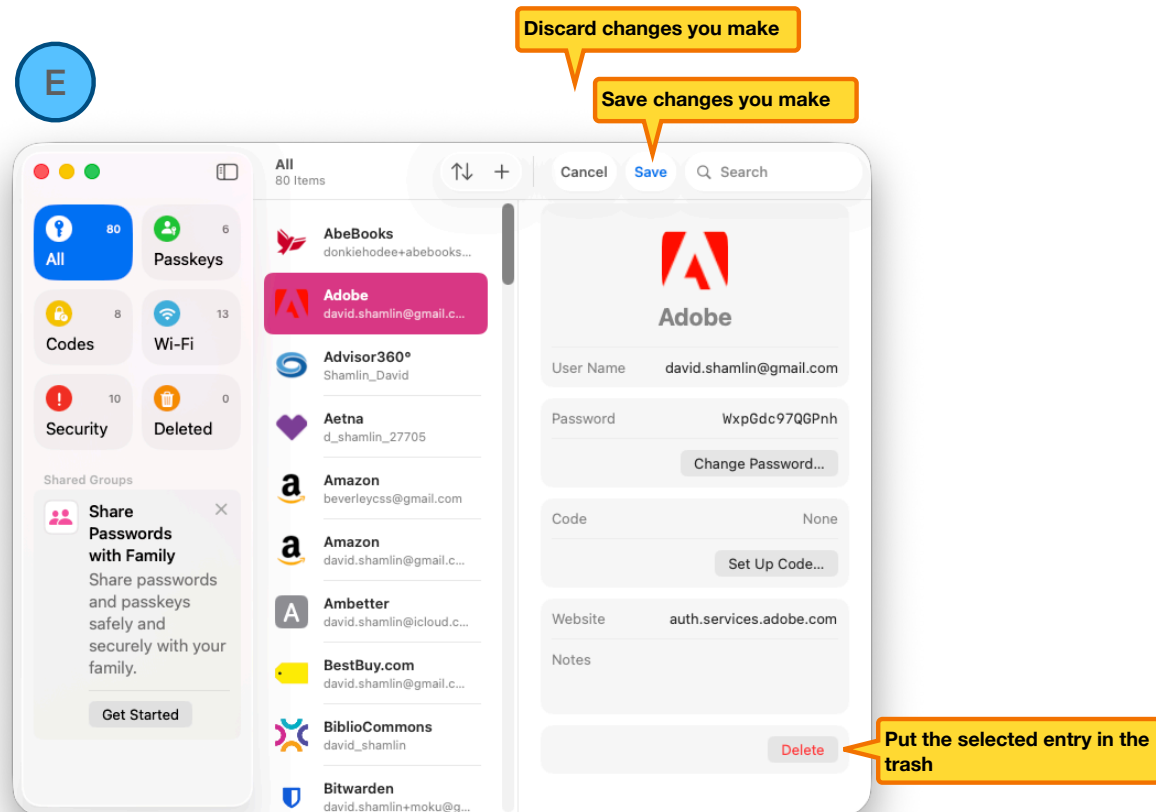
Passwords App UI on MacBooks



Passwords App UI on MacBook

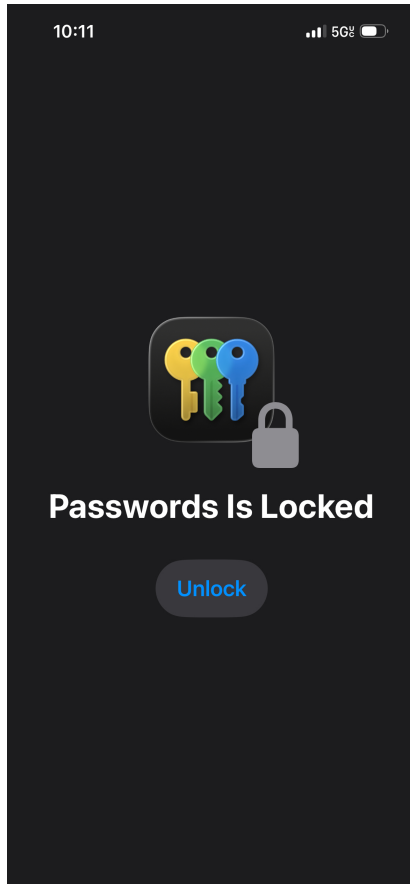


Passwords App UI on MacBook

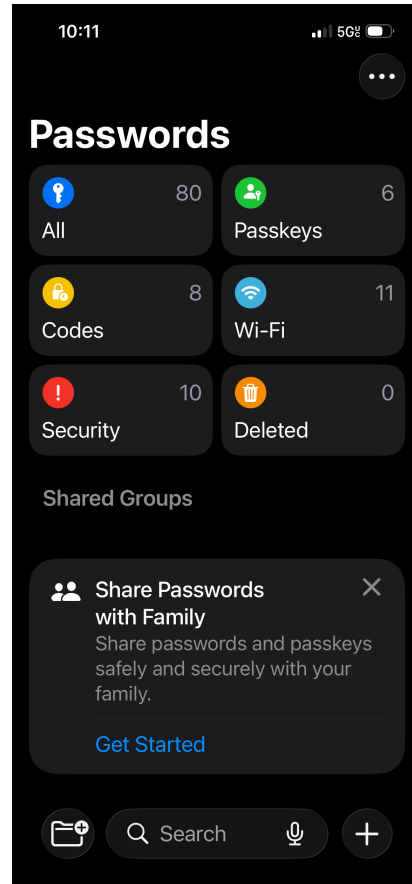


Passwords App UI on iPhone

A

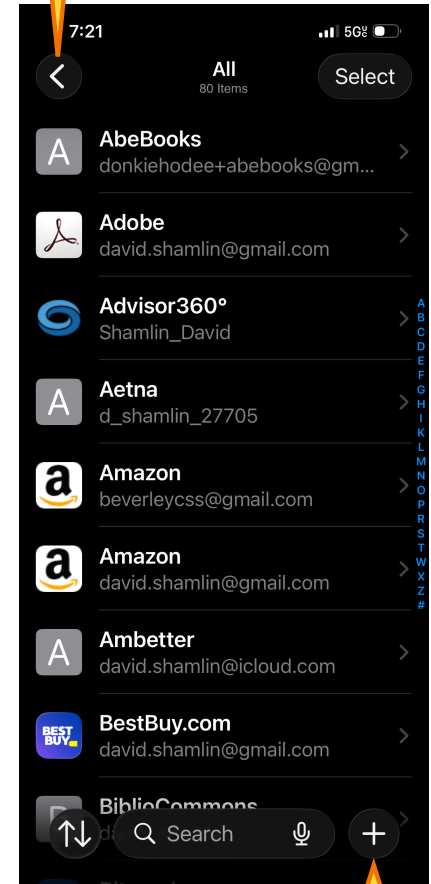


B



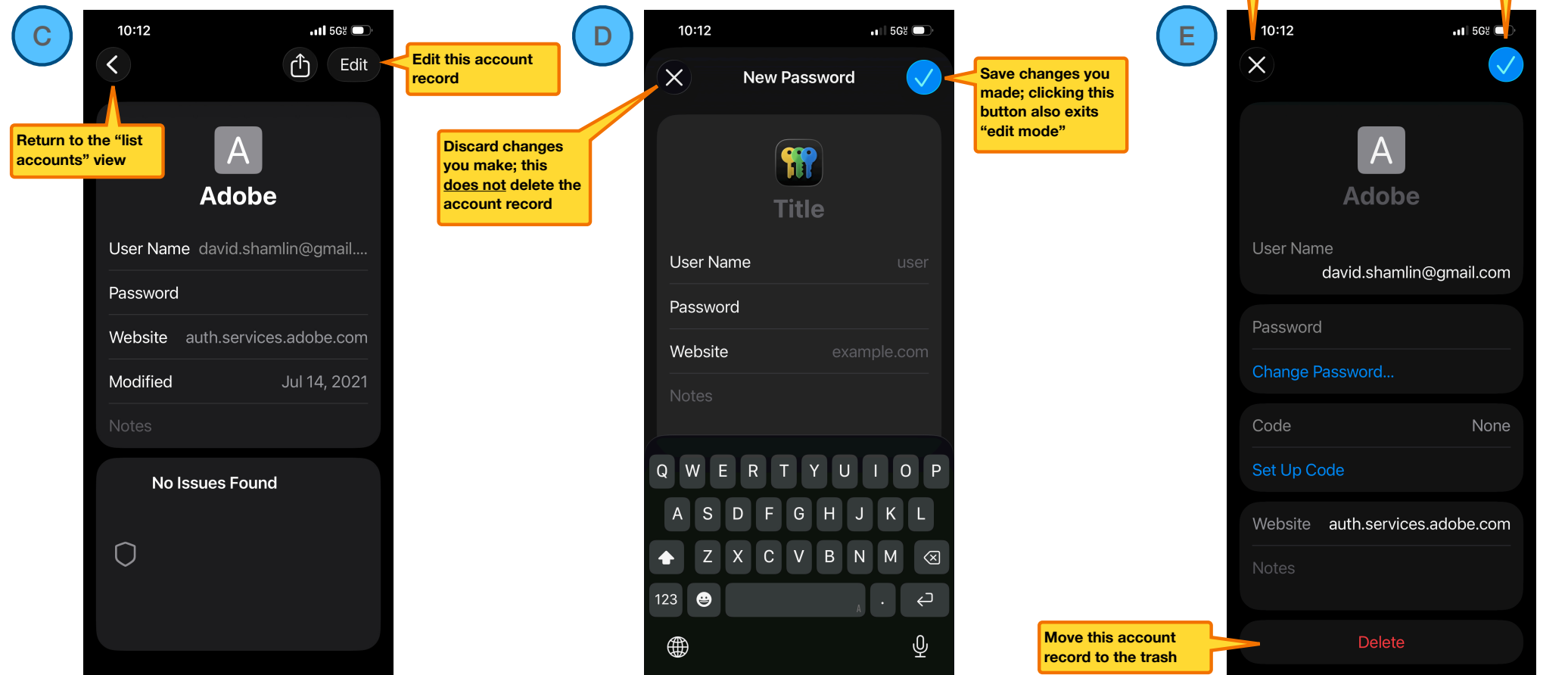
This view is the same as the side panel you see on Mac and iPad; click/tap the "All" control to see all your accounts (screenshot to the right.)

Return to the view on the left



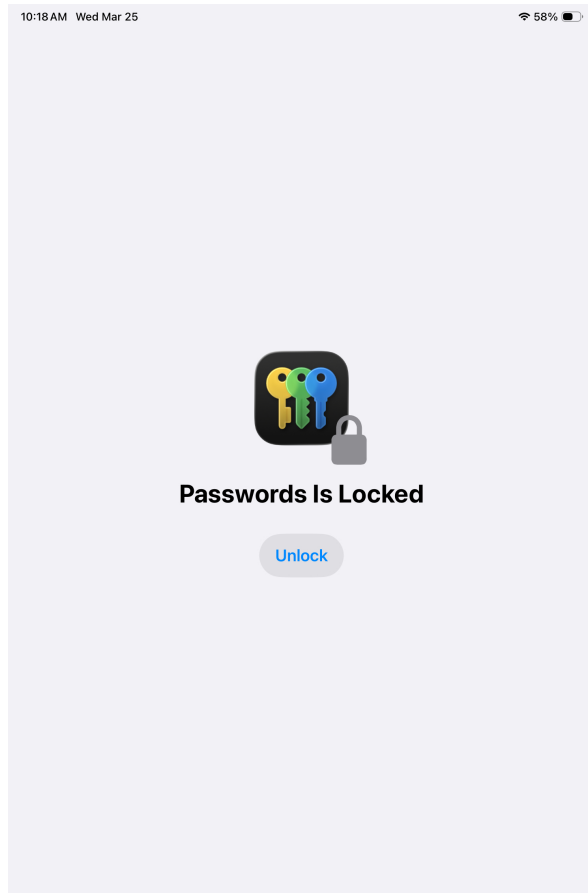
Add a new account

Passwords App UI on iPhone

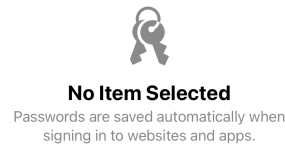
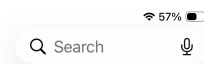
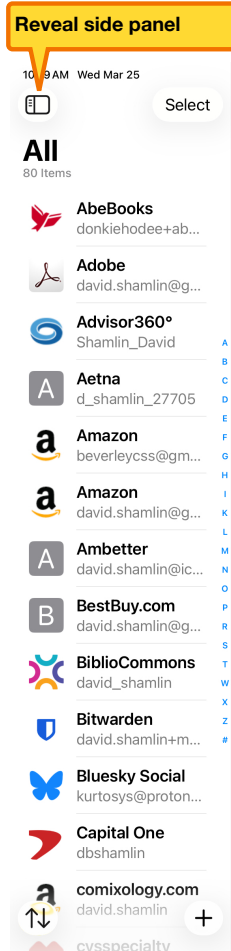


Passwords App UI on iPad

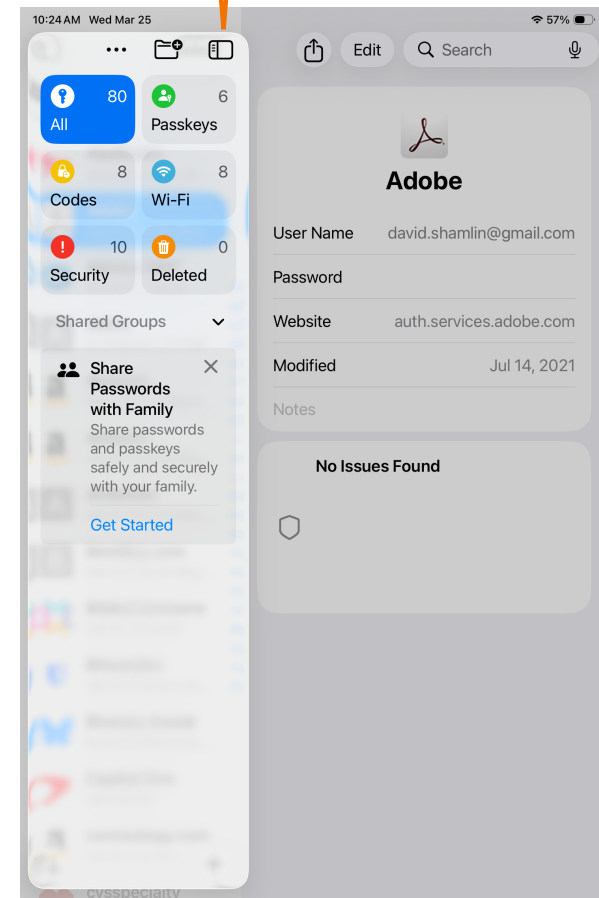
A



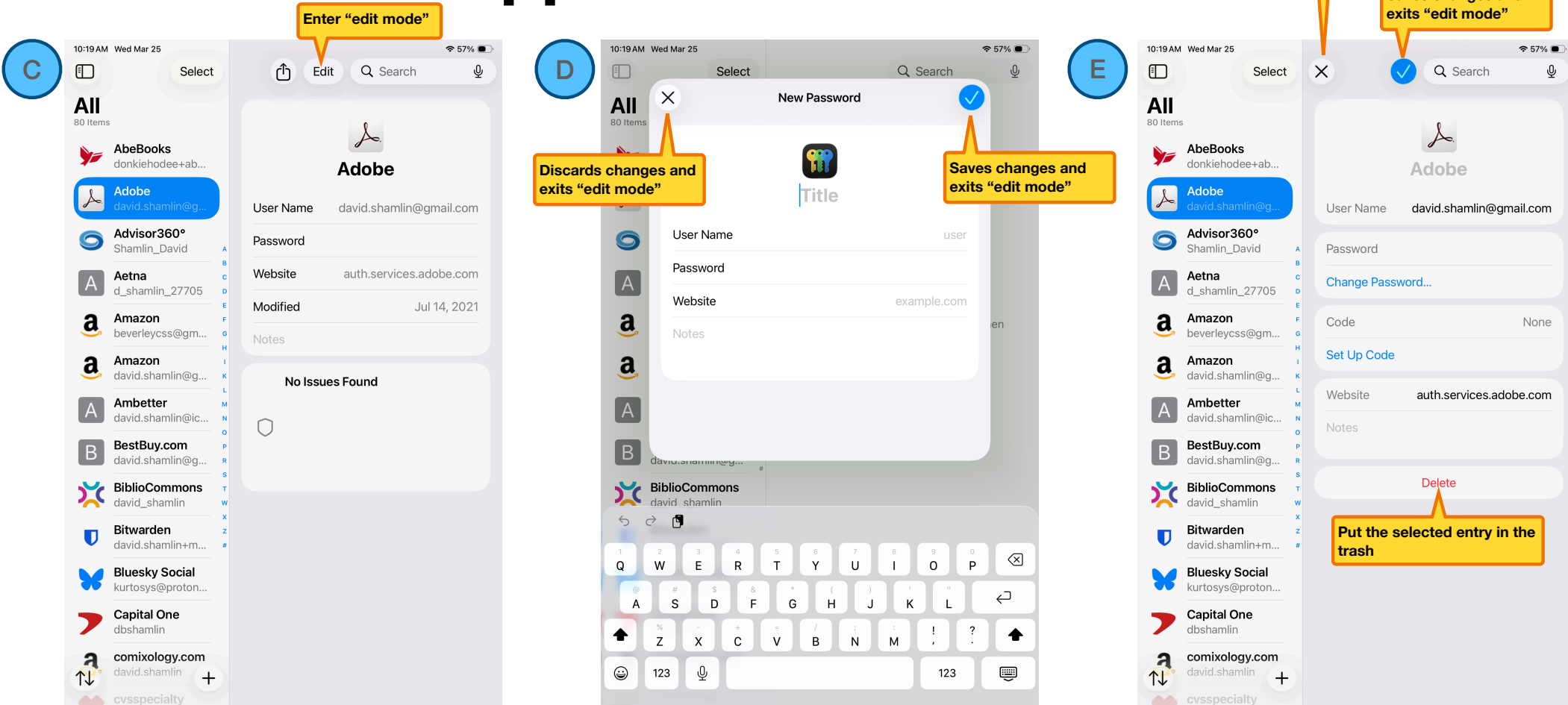
B



Hide side panel



Passwords App UI on iPad



References: Help Guide Pages

- Apple Passwords app [overview page](#)
Note: this page contains links to Mac, iPhone, and iPad specific help guide pages
- macOS (i.e., Macbooks and Mac desktops)
 - [Passwords User Guide](#)
 - [Learn how passwords are used on Mac](#)
 - [Use passwords on your Mac](#)
 - [Change weak or compromised passwords in Passwords on Mac](#)
- iPhone: [Use passwords on iPhone](#)
- iPad: [Use passwords on iPad](#)

Note regarding iPhone and iPad references: The iPhone and iPad references take you to the first page of the Passwords app “chapter” in each of those device’s help guide. To see a list of all pages related to the Passwords app in either guide:

1. Find the “Table of Contents” control near the top of the page
2. Click on “Table of Contents”; a pop-up will appear
3. Scroll down the pop-up till you get to the section labelled “Passwords”

References

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